Omar Sharaf

Director of Data Engineering · AI/ML & MLOps

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SUMMARY

Director of Data Engineering with 7+ years in data engineering and AI/ML at Fortune 100 companies. Led four engineering teams that delivered six Gen AI applications in 18 months, including Travelers' first Gen AI application for external brokers, and doubled the number of ML models in production. Cuts production job runtimes from hours to minutes and brings AI-native engineering practices to data teams. AWS certified; completing an M.S. in Data Science.

CORE SKILLS

Leadership: Engineering Management, Team Building & Mentorship, Stakeholder Partnership, SAFe Agile, Offshore Team Management

AI/ML: Generative AI, RAG, GPT, MLOps, Real-time & Batch Models

Cloud & Data: AWS, Databricks, Snowflake, Terraform, Docker, Neo4j, MongoDB, Teradata, Hadoop

Languages & Tools: Python, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, R, CI/CD, Tableau, Angular

EXPERIENCE

Director of Data Engineering — Pricing Model Support Feb 2026 – Present

The Travelers Companies Hartford, CT (Hybrid)

- Inherited a team with no testing, weak code hygiene, and no delivery standards; within two weeks established hardened CI/CD pipelines, code-quality gates, and production-release controls.
- Manage a team of five; onboarded and upskilled four engineers, embedding AI-native workflows with Claude and related tools.
- Partner closely with recruiting to attract and hire top engineering talent, building a high-performing team.
- Converted a data scientist's prototype into production-grade code in under 24 hours using Claude Code, validated and signed off by data science.
- Cut a critical production job from up to 8 hours to 30 minutes, moving the team from chronically missed SLAs to consistently beating them.
- Reduced an 11-hour job to 1 hour 40 minutes, letting the business run models and make decisions during the workday instead of overnight.
- Introduced Agile sprints and serve as de facto product owner, building epics and features with the business while staying hands-on in code.
- Became the go-to partner for actuaries and data scientists; coach peers and engineers outside the team to raise the engineering bar across lines of business.

Technical Engineering Manager — Gen AI / MLOps Aug 2024 – Feb 2026
The Travelers Companies Hartford, CT (Hybrid)

- Led an MLOps team that doubled the number of models in production, clearing the entire pricing backlog until data science ran out of models to deploy.
- Built turnkey deployment patterns and R2I integration, enabling model-to-production turnaround within 24 hours with the same team size, before AI tooling.
- Championed Copilot and early AI tooling to boost team efficiency and grow engineers' technical depth.
- Stepped up to lead four teams after my manager's departure, spanning data products, AI intake pipelines, and Gen AI applications.
- Led the team that deployed Travelers' first Gen AI application to production for external brokers, not just internal users.
- Delivered six Gen AI applications in 18 months across RAG and AI intake use cases.
- Managed up to 11 ICs, including mid-year and year-end reviews, while staying a hands-on IC lead across all four teams.

Cloud Data Engineer — Gen AI / MLOps Mar 2024 – Aug 2024
The Travelers Companies Hartford, CT (Hybrid)

- Led development and deployment of real-time and batch machine-learning models within the MLOps ecosystem.
- Lead developer on the company's first RAG application, built on GPT-3.5.
- Partnered with business stakeholders to define technical priorities and mentored junior engineers.
- Streamlined onboarding so new permanent and temporary hires became productive quickly.

Data Engineer Oct 2022 – Mar 2024
The Travelers Companies Hybrid, United States

- Built an automation tool that converts SQL Server DDLs to a new data storage solution.
- Developed a Neo4j API and frontend to visualize database hierarchy and improve data visibility.
- Created a testing framework and established Snowflake deployment standards across the line of business.

Data Engineer Jun 2021 – Sep 2022
The Cigna Group (CGI Inc consultant) Bloomfield, CT

- Designed and implemented multiple Python automation tools and frameworks.
- Delivered incrementally within SAFe agile teams.
- Developed procedures to extract and transform base-table data for downstream applications.

Programmer Analyst Jun 2018 – Jun 2021
The Cigna Group (CGI Inc consultant) Bloomfield, CT

- Built Python REST APIs retrieving data from Hadoop, Teradata, and Oracle.
- Developed Angular applications and reusable components in Docker containers.
- Delivered business-critical reports via Hadoop ELT and Tableau.
- Used and debugged CI/CD pipelines to deploy Angular apps and Python APIs.

EDUCATION

M.S., Data Science (in progress), Central Connecticut State University Jan 2022 – Present
B.A., Economics, University of Connecticut Aug 2014 – Dec 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, Amazon Web Services Apr 2021